ROBIN SHANHOLTZ

New York, NY | robinshanholtz95@gmail.com

EDUCATION

Northwestern University 06/2025 – Present
M.A., Clinical Mental Health Counseling Expected graduation 08/2027
GPA: 4.0/4.0

Northeastern University 09/2013 – 08/2017
B.S., Computer Science and Cognitive Psychology Boston, MA
GPA: 3.48/4.0

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant, Center for Conflict and Cooperation 10/2025 – Present
New York University | PI: Jay Van Bavel, PhD; Supervisor: Rémi Thériault, PhD *New York, NY*

Effects of reading nonfiction on prosocial behavior (main study and pilot)

- Developed interactive behavioral tasks in jsPsych and embedded them within a Qualtrics survey.
- Drafted and submitted the IRB application for the pilot study, securing approval to conduct the research, and completed IRB-requested revisions.
- Wrote an R script that automatically generated highlightable Qualtrics questions from book chapters, substantially reducing manual survey-building time.

Meta-analysis on the effects of reading fiction vs. nonfiction 11/2025 – Present

- Ran a preliminary meta-analysis in R across hundreds of studies to estimate the effect of reading nonfiction vs. fiction.
- Presented findings at lab meeting, leading the team to focus further analysis on the type of nonfiction read.

Lab infrastructure

- Created and maintained the lab's GitHub repository to organize and version project code.
- Led a lab discussion, "Book Project Design: Economic Games and Alternative Paradigms" (2026).

Research Assistant, Queer Thriving and Resilience Lab 12/2025 – Present
Northwestern University | PI: Vanessa Dominguez, PhD *Remote*

Queering the Family Lifecycle (conceptual manuscript) 12/2025 – Present

- Co-authored the manuscript, writing portions of the introduction and a section on found family and emerging adulthood; conducted supporting literature reviews.

Queer Family Stress 2026

- Collaborated on and submitted a SEED grant application to fund the project.

Trauma-Informed Supervision (book chapter) 2026

- Conducted a literature review and built an annotated bibliography for the PI's chapter.

Independent project: Online communities as a resource for transgender counseling clients 2026

- Designed and led a literature review on online peer support communities and transgender client needs; presented findings as a poster at the SAIGE Conference.
- Developed a guide for counselors without training in transgender care on integrating online community resources into treatment.

Research Assistant, Phonology Lab 01/2015 – 05/2015
Northeastern University | PI: Dr. Iris Berent *Boston, MA*

- Coordinated experiments measuring phoneme reaction time; recorded and coded participant data.

MANUSCRIPTS IN PREPARATION

Dominguez, V., Wheatley, J., MacKay, S., Listrom, O., **Shanholtz, R.**, Biche, J., & Rosile, J., (in preparation). *Queering the family lifecycle*.

Thériault, R., Choi, B., Goldstein, B., **Shanholtz, R**., Ramy, A., et al. (in preparation). *Reading books changes lives: Investigating the effects of popular psychology books on prosociality and polarization.*

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

Shanholtz, R. (2026, October). *Trans Learning: Rooted in Online Trans Communities* [Poster presentation]. Society for Sexual, Affectional, Intersex, and Gender Expansive Identities (SAIGE) Conference, Seattle, WA.

Dominguez, V., Biche, J. H., **Shanholtz, R.**, Rosile, J., & Wheatley, J. (2026, October 23–24). *Rooted in chosen family: Queering the family life cycle – Reframing family development, identity, aging, and end-of-life decisions* [Conference presentation]. Society for Sexual, Affectional, Intersex, and Gender Expansive Identities (SAIGE) Conference, Seattle, WA.

Thériault, R., Choi, B., Goldstein, B., Ramy, A., **Shanholtz, R.**, Guilas, A.-C., Rathje, S., Globig, L., & Van Bavel, J. (2025, December). *Can books reduce polarization? AI-generated simulations of reading non-fiction chapters* [Poster presentation]. MIT Polarization Workshop, Cambridge, MA.

GRANTS

Queer Family Stress. SEED grant application, The Family Institute, Northwestern University Queer Thriving and Resilience Lab (submitted 2026, under review). PI: Vanessa Dominguez, PhD. Role: Contributor.

CLINICAL EXPERIENCE

Practicum Counselor-in-Training, PMA Mental Health 03/2026 – Present
Supervisor: Robert York, LMHC New York, NY

- Provide individual counseling to low acuity private practice clients; 84 direct client hours to date, 228 indirect hours.
- Developing a counseling group for transgender clients at the practice to support affirming care and community-building.
- Guided and served as a consultant to colleagues seeking guidance on affirming care for transgender clients.

Volunteer Crisis Counselor, Crisis Text Line 04/2025 – Present
Remote

- Supported 50+ texters in crisis through de-escalation and safety planning; completed 40-hour crisis counseling training.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Software Engineer, Meta 2017 – 2025
Privacy and Live Video teams *New York, NY*

- Led a team of 3 engineers building privacy products used by Facebook's users, including Off-Facebook Activity, Activity Log, and Privacy Checkup, and later Live Video products such as Live Q&A.
- Led weekly company-wide incident reviews to resolve and prevent privacy issues; helped Meta meet privacy regulations, including GDPR.
- Drove large-scale cost-saving efforts for the Video team, saving tens of millions of dollars.
- Served as Intern Director for three terms, coaching intern managers; managed and mentored two interns to full-time offers.

Software Engineering Intern, Meta 2016
Infrastructure Efficiency team *Menlo Park, CA*

- Designed automation software that identified cost regressions between functions, reducing investigation time.

SKILLS

Programming & data: R (incl. meta-analysis), JavaScript, jsPsych, Qualtrics (custom JavaScript), Git/GitHub, Python, SQL

Research: IRB applications, literature reviews, annotated bibliographies, grant writing, manuscript writing

Privacy & security: privacy engineering, regulatory compliance (GDPR), incident review

HONORS AND AWARDS

Emerging Scholar Fall 2025 – Present
Northwestern University
Scholarship award of $1,300 per quarter